

Mary Lind, M.A.

Ph.D. student

Binghamton, NY, United States

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Violent non-state actors, cyber conflict, repression technologies, military technologies, disinformation, human rights

EDUCATION

Binghamton University (SUNY), Binghamton, NY, United States

August 2023 — present

Ph.D. in Political Science

Binghamton University (SUNY), Binghamton, NY, United States

August 2023 — May 2025

M.A. in Political Science

University of Rhode Island, Kingston, RI, United States

August 2022 — May 2023

M.A. in International Relations (4+1)

Concentration: Global Peace Studies

University of Rhode Island, Kingston, RI, United States

September 2018 — May 2022

B.A. Journalism, B.A. Political Science

Summa cum laude

SKILLS

- **Writing** Copy editing, content editing, academic writing, journalistic writing
- **Software:** R, Quarto, Adobe InDesign
- **Other:** Teaching, public speaking

PUBLICATIONS

1. **“Human Rights in the United States.”** (*Forthcoming in PS: Political Science & Politics with K. Chad Clay & Meredith Lavelle*)

Part of a special issue for which the three of us are co-guest editors. In this introductory paper, we compare the United States’ human rights performance across several human rights measurement projects and set the scene for the rest of the special issue.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

1. Lavelle, Meredith and **Mary Lind**. “The New United Nations Treaty Against Cybercrime: International Cooperation to Combat Cybercrime, or A Framework for Transnational Digital Surveillance?” (*Forthcoming in The Conversation*)
We evaluate the treaty’s stated human rights commitments against its provisions, civil society responses, and key concerns regarding transnational surveillance.
2. Mark, Skip and **Mary Lind**. 2023. “A Problem of Our Own Making: Understanding Child Labor in the United States.” *VerfBlog*, May 13.
3. **Lind, Mary**. 2021. “Three candidates for Lieutenant Governor of R.I. hope to bring something new to the role: Youth.” *The Boston Globe*, March 3.

WORKING PAPERS

1. **“Digital frontlines: How cyber conflict reshapes the relationships between states, insurgents, and citizens.”** (*Dissertation*) I am collecting original data on the adoption and use of cyber conflict capabilities by violent non-state actors, asking under what circumstances this is the most likely to occur and how it fits into their tactical repertoire. This is the second chapter of my dissertation. More specifically, I apply an opportunity and willingness framework to assess determinants of VNSA use and adoption of cyber conflict tactics, and in a subsequent chapter analyze whether or not cyber operations are complements or substitutes to VNSA violence against civilians.
2. **“Digital Damage Control: Cyber Conflict and its Implications for Domestic Repression”**

I argue that digital repression in the form of internet shutdowns is an unexpected effect of cyberattacks as governments attempt to mitigate the damage caused by the attack. This is the first chapter of my dissertation.

3. “Opportunity, willingness, and the adoption of cyber capabilities by militant groups”

I am collecting original data on the adoption and use of cyber conflict capabilities by violent non-state actors, asking under what circumstances this is the most likely to occur. This is the second chapter of my dissertation.

4. “Armed and online: Cyber capabilities and insurgent violence”

Building on original data collected for the second chapter of my dissertation, I examine how cyber operations fit into militant groups’ tactical repertoires, including how they change the utility of engaging in civilian-targeted violence.

5. “Cyber norm initiation in the international system.” (with Seden Akcinaroglu, Jeson Li, Alice Hong, & Yusuf Evrigen).

We argue that although states have a shared interest in developing norms surrounding conduct in cyberspace, the different internal and external threats that they face lead them to have different ideas as to what these norms should be, preventing a consensus from being reached.

OTHER RESEARCH

Mapping Militants Project

Graduate Research Assistant

Rice University (Remote), United States

April 2026 — Present

- Editing militant group profiles written by undergraduate students for content and copy.
- Conducting additional research to update militant group profiles

CIRIGHTS Dataset

Graduate Research Assistant

Kingston, RI, United States

September 2022 — August 2023

- Coded data on human trafficking and worker’s rights based on US State Department Reports.

Mapping Misinformation

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Kingston, RI, United States

January 2022 — May 2022

- Researched misinformation surrounding COVID-19 and Critical Race Theory.

Get Housing Right

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Kingston, RI, United States

June 2021 — May 2022

- Conducted door-to-door surveys of public housing residents in Southern Rhode Island asking about their satisfaction with their living situation to inform statewide housing policy & research.

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Harpur Academic Advising (Binghamton University)

Summer Assistant

Binghamton, NY, United States

June 2025 — August 2025

- Assisted professional academic advisors with course scheduling for incoming first-year and transfer students.
- Answered phone calls and emails at front desk.

URI Office of External Communications & Media

Intern

Kingston, RI, United States

May 2022 — August 2022

- Wrote & edited articles (for copy & content) for publication on the University website.

United States Senate

Intern, Office of Sen. Sheldon Whitehouse (D-RI)

Remote

January 2022 — May 2022

- Assisted staff with research on local & national issues relevant to Rhode Islanders.
- Answered constituent phone calls and emails and passed information along to senior staff.

URI Undergraduate Writing Center

Writing Consultant

Kingston, RI, United States

June 2020 — August 2021

- Assisted students with brainstorming, drafting, and editing written work for courses, personal statements, and graduate/law/medical school applications.

The Good Five Cent Cigar (URI Student Newspaper)

Production Manager

Kingston, RI, United States

January 2019 — December 2021

- Edited (for copy & content) & wrote dozens of news, feature, and entertainment articles.

- Pitched articles to staff.
- Designed the layout of the weekly print newspaper.

Contributing Reporter

September 2018 — May 2022

- Wrote news & feature articles.

Rhode Island General Assembly

Providence, RI, United States

Legislative Press Intern

June 2018 — August 2018; June 2019 — August 2019

- Edited & wrote press releases about Rhode Island state legislators.
- Assisted with creating and filing daily reports of news coverage of Rhode Island federal and state legislators.

Legislative Page

January 2018 — June 2018; May 2019 — June 2019

- Assisted legislators & staff during session by running errands, delivering items, and

TEACHING**Binghamton University (SUNY)**

Binghamton, NY, United States

Instructor of Record

- PLSC 380C: Politics & Technology

Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant

- PLSC/HMRT 100: Introduction to Human Rights
- PLSC 111: Introduction to American Politics
- PLSC 117: Introduction to World Politics

Spring 2025

Spring 2024

Fall 2023, Fall 2024

University of Rhode Island

Kingston, RI, United States

Graduate Teaching Assistant

- PSC 310: Introduction to Political Science Research
- PSC 116: Introduction to International Politics
- PSC 113: Introduction to American Politics

Fall 2022, Spring 2023

Spring 2023

Fall 2022

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

- JOR 110: Introduction to Mass Media
- PSC 310: Introduction to Political Science Research

Fall 2021, Spring 2022

Spring 2021

PRESENTATIONS

1. “Roundtable on Academic Freedom and Protecting Data/Practices.” *Consortium for Rights Analysis and Measurement (CRAM) Spring 2026 Workshop*. Kingston, Rhode Island, May 2026.
2. “Digital damage control: Cyber conflict and its implications for domestic repression.” *Consortium for Rights Analysis and Measurement (CRAM) Spring 2026 Workshop*. Kingston, Rhode Island, May 2026.
3. “Digital damage control: Cyberattacks and the logic of online censorship” *2026 Annual Meeting of the New England Political Science Association*. Burlington, Vermont, April 2026.
4. “Cyber norm initiation in the international system.” *82nd Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference*. Chicago, Illinois, April 2025.
5. “Messages vs. Messengers: Examining the Impact of Civil Society Stakeholders and State Relationships on UPR Recommendations.” *Second Annual Workshop of the Consortium for Human Rights Analysis & Measurement (CRAM)*, Kingston, RI, June 2024.
6. “Coups, Uprisings, and Human Rights: Do the Differences Matter?” *80th Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference*. Chicago, Illinois, April 2023. *With Ashlea Rundlett*.
7. “CIRIGHTS & You: How can you use this data?” *Launching CIRIGHTS: The World’s Largest Human Rights Database*, Kingston, RI, December 2022
8. “Mapping Misinformation: Effects and correction of false information.” *How to be Media Literate Citizens*, URI Harrington School of Communication & Media, Kingston, RI, March 2022. *With Ekaterina Sylvester, Skip Mark, Juliet Waromi, Shawn Fennell, and Lauren Smith*.
9. “Where can I catch the bus? Access to Public Transportation for Public Housing Residents in Rhode Island & Suggestions for Improvement.” *Ninth Annual Pi Sigma Alpha National Student Research Conference*, virtual via Zoom, March 2022.

HONORS & AWARDS

University Academic Excellence Award in Political Science	May 2022
David Warren International Relations Award	April 2021
Eric F. Kumpf Memorial Scholarship Award	April 2020
Rhode Island PBS Scholarship	2019-2022
Journalism Education Association Rhode Island Student Journalist of the Year	2018

REFERENCES

Prof. Seden Akcinaroglu

Professor, Department of Political Science, Binghamton University (SUNY); Binghamton, NY, United States

Email: sakcinar@binghamton.edu

Google Scholar

Prof. Skip Mark

Associate Professor, Department of Political Science, University of Rhode Island; Kingston, RI, United States

Email: skipmark@uri.edu

Google Scholar